

# Sayantan Chakraborty

Assistant Professor, Department of Humanities and Social Sciences — BITS Pilani, Dubai Campus

Environmental Humanities · Health Humanities · Postcolonial Literature · Indigenous Literary Studies

## Research Profile

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My research builds new intellectual connections between literary studies and contemporary environmental, health, cultural, and social challenges through interdisciplinary analytical frameworks that bring ideas, methods, and perspectives from different disciplines into productive dialogue. This approach informs my work across Environmental Humanities, Health Humanities, Indian English and Postcolonial Literatures, and Indigenous Literary Studies, while also shaping my teaching, mentorship, and creative practice.

## Research Interests

- **Health and Medical Humanities:** Health Humanities, Food Humanities, Narrative Medicine
- **Environmental Humanities and Sustainability:** Ecocriticism, Environmental Education, Energy Humanities
- **Literature, Culture and Society:** Indian English Literature, Postcolonial Literature, Indigenous Literary Studies, Comparative Literature
- **Creative Practice and Public Humanities:** Creative Writing, Film Adaptation, Literary Festivals

## Faculty Appointments

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**15 Dec 2020 – Present** — Assistant Professor, Department of Humanities and Social Sciences, Birla Institute of Technology and Science, Pilani, Dubai Campus

**6 May 2019 – 6 Dec 2019** — Assistant Professor, Department of English, KL University, Andhra Pradesh

**21 Jan 2019 – 30 Apr 2019** — Assistant Professor, Department of English, Ganpat University, Gujarat

## Education

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**2019** — Ph.D. in English, Central University of Tamil Nadu

**2012** — National Eligibility Test (NET), University Grants Commission (June & Dec 2012)

**2011** — Post Graduate Certificate in the Teaching of English (PGCTE), English and Foreign Languages University

**2011** — M.Phil. in English, University of Burdwan

**2007** — M.A. in English, Banaras Hindu University

**2005** — B.A. (Honours) in English, University of Burdwan

## Publications

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### Journal Articles

1. Chakraborty, S. "Indigenous Cultural Relocation in Desmond Kharmawphlang's Poems." *Archiv Orientalni* 93, no. 2 (2025): 337–356.
2. Chakraborty, S. "The Heritage of Hynñiew Trep in Desmond Kharmawphlang's Poems." *South Asia: Journal of South Asian Studies* 48, no. 1 (2025): 141–154.
3. Chakraborty, S. "Traditional Land, Postcolonial Development, and Indigenous Ecocriticism in Esther Syiem's Poems." *Journal of Postcolonial Writing* 60, no. 3 (2024): 285–300.
4. Chakraborty, S. "'Forgetting the Stories Would Be Catastrophic': Writing the Oral and Protecting the Place in the Poems of Temsula Ao and Esther Syiem." *GeoHumanities* 6, no. 1 (2020): 51–64.
5. Chakraborty, S. "Khasi Hills and Khasi Culture: Reconnection in Kynpham Sing Nongkynrih's *The Yearning of Seeds*." *The Journal of Commonwealth Literature* 55, no. 2 (2020): 259–276.
6. Chakraborty, S. "Versifying Culture: Reading the Ethnographic Poems of Temsula Ao." *Interventions* 19, no. 1 (2017): 108–125.
7. Chakraborty, S. "Naga Pastoral? The Post-Pastoral Possibilities in Temsula Ao's Hill Poems." *The Journal of Commonwealth Literature* 51, no. 3 (2016): 358–370.

### Book Chapters

1. "Stones and Ao-Naga Culture: A Geographical Reading of Temsula Ao's Stone Poems." In *Contemporary Indian English Poetry and Drama*, eds. Sinha, Bhattacharya & Lahiri, 101–112. Cambridge Scholars Publishing, 2019.
2. "Writing Nature, Reviving Culture: Geographies of Materiality in Snelson L. Chyne's *Echo from the Hills*." In *Critical Perspectives on the Post-1980 Indian Novel in English*, ed. K. V. Raghupathi, 218–233. Yking Books, 2017.
3. "Rooted in Tradition: Echo of the Oral Tradition in Kynpham Sing Nongkynrih's Poems." In *Indian Writing in English: Current Critical Approaches*, Vol. 3, ed. M. Solayan, 263–268. Universal Publishers, 2014.
4. "Living in the Hills: A Geographical Reading of Temsula Ao's Hill Poems." In *Gender Perspectives: South Asian Writings in English and in English Translations*, eds. Chakraborti & Chandel, 163–177. 2014.

### Book Reviews

1. Nanda, K. & Chakraborty, S. Review of *Interrogating Eco-Literature and Sustainable Development*. *Journal of Postcolonial Writing* 61, no. 3 (2024): 460–461.

## Ongoing Research Projects

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**EDITED VOLUME — Beyond Empathy: Critical Directions in Health Humanities** (co-edited with Prof. Shazi Shah Jabeen); manuscript under development for Bloomsbury (expected Feb 2027).

**JOURNAL ARTICLE — Teaching Renewable Energy Critically: Slow Violence and Wind Energy in Indian Environmental Education Textbooks** (with Prof. Harpreet Singh Bedi); intended for the *Journal of Environmental Education*.

**MONOGRAPH — Indigenous Ecopoetry: Reconnection, Postcolonial Development and Khasi Poets.**

**BOOK REVIEW —** Review of *Postcolonial Poetry and the Environment* (2025) by Pramod K. Nayar, for *Journal of Postcolonial Writing*.

## Grants and Fellowships

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- Travel Grant, BITS Pilani, 7th World Conference on Social Sciences (WORLDCSS), Zurich, Switzerland, 5–7 July 2024
- Travel and Subsistence Grant, Irish Studies Summer School, Queen's University, Belfast, Jul–Aug 2014
- Honorary Fellow (appointed), Center for Research on Gender and Women, University of Wisconsin–Madison, USA (Sept 2023–Aug 2024)

## Scholarly Engagement

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### INVITED LECTURES & KEYNOTES

- "Reading Illness Ecologically" — Carl von Ossietzky University, Germany, 21 Sept 2026
- Environmental Humanities Reading Group, Rachel Carson Centre, Germany, 16 Dec 2024
- Invited lecture, VIT Chennai, India, 15 Feb 2023
- Plenary Talk, Government College Una, H.P., 15–16 Nov 2024

### SELECTED CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- 7th World Conference on Social Sciences (WorldCSS), 5–7 July 2024
- Central University of Jammu — Redrawing the Boundaries of Ecocritical Discourse, 21–22 Jul 2022 (also chaired a session)
- Network of Asian Environmental Philosophy (NAEP) Symposium, June 2022

## Teaching and Research Supervision

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### PHD SUPERVISION (ONGOING)

- Kritika Nanda — Representational Justice in Early-Onset Alzheimer's Narratives
- Rachita Arora — Environmental Humanities
- Chandrika Lade — Environmental Humanities

### PHD COURSEWORK

- Research Practice · Reading Course I
- Advanced Topics I & II
- Research Project I & II · Case Studies I

### UNDERGRADUATE COURSES

- Technical Report Writing · Linguistics
- Creative Writing · Ecocriticism
- Literary Criticism · Environment, Development & Climate Change

### CURRICULUM DEVELOPMENT

*Designed interdisciplinary undergraduate courses (Environmental Ethics, Environmental Humanities) and doctoral courses (Scholarly Writing, Sustainability Studies, Environmental Humanities, Research Methods in Humanities) submitted for institutional approval.*

## Creative Practice

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- **Novel** — *The Last Leftist Historian* (in progress; first complete draft finished)
- **Screenplay Adaptation & Translation** — *Knasaiparer Ekbochor* (2024, in progress)
- **Stage Direction** — *Inna Ki Aawaz* (Asghar Wajahat) and *Ladai* (Sarveshwar Dayal Saxena), Central University of Tamil Nadu

## Academic Leadership & Service

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Convener (DRC) and Project Based Learning Co-ordinator, Dept. of HSS · NAAC & CAA Committee Member · DCA/CCDCA Committee Member · Faculty In-Charge, Public Speaking and Literary Club · Hostel Warden · Mess Committee Chairperson · Standing Committee for Students' Discipline · Library Committee.

*Conceptualised and organised an international Distinguished Lecture Series in Indigenous Studies and Health Humanities, hosting speakers from University of Wisconsin–Madison, National Sun Yat–Sen University, University of Hawai'i, University of Georgia, University of Washington, and others (2021–2026).*

## Entrepreneurship Mentorship

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Mentors students in start-up incubation, pitch preparation, investor engagement, and career counselling — including Genme (medical supply chain), BitBotRobotics (autonomous drone delivery), MyAmaani (tourism), Zisto (cloud kitchen), and QuillStone (holding company).

## Professional Service

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*Peer Reviewer* — *The Journal of Commonwealth Literature* · *Interventions* · *Journal of Postcolonial Writing* · *Social Change* · *AlterNative* · *DECISION* (IIM Calcutta) · *Social Identities* · *Frontiers in Sociology* · *Bloomsbury Publishing*.